PART 4: BUSINESS INSIGHTS

4.1 Five Key Business Insights

1. The West region leads in sales and profit performance.
The West recorded the highest sales of $725,457.82 and profit of $108,418.45, followed by the East with $678,781.24 in sales and $91,522.78 in profit. The Central region recorded $501,239.89 in sales and $39,706.36 in profit, while the South recorded $391,721.91 in sales and $46,749.43 in profit. This shows that the West and East are the strongest regions by both sales and profit.

2. Consumer customers contribute the largest share of revenue.
The Consumer segment accounts for 50.56% of total sales, followed by Corporate at 30.74% and Home Office at 18.70%. This indicates that individual consumers are the company's largest customer group and play a major role in revenue generation.

3. Technology generates the highest sales and profit among the three categories.
Technology recorded $836,154.03 in sales and $145,454.95 in profit. Office Supplies generated $719,047.03 in sales and $122,490.80 in profit, while Furniture recorded $741,999.80 in sales and $18,451.27 in profit. Although Furniture sales were higher than Office Supplies sales, its profit was substantially lower, suggesting a need to investigate its costs, discounting, and product mix.

4. Profitability varies significantly across product sub-categories.
Copiers generated the highest sub-category profit at $55,617.82, followed by Phones at $44,515.73 and Accessories at $41,936.64. However, Tables recorded a loss of $17,725.48, Bookcases lost $3,472.56, and Supplies lost $1,189.10. This demonstrates that some product sub-categories reduce overall profitability and may require pricing or cost reviews.

5. Sales and profit performance differ across states and individual products.
California led state-level sales with $457,687.63 and profit of $76,381.39, while North Dakota recorded only $919.91 in sales and $230.15 in profit. At the product level, the Canon imageCLASS 2200 Advanced Copier generated $61,599.82 in sales and $25,199.93 in profit. In contrast, the Cisco TelePresence System EX90 generated $22,638.48 in sales but recorded a loss of $1,811.08. These results highlight differences in geographic demand and product profitability.

4.2 Three Business Risks

1. Losses from unprofitable products.
Tables, Bookcases, and Supplies recorded negative profits of $17,725.48, $3,472.56, and

$1,189.10 respectively. Continuing to sell these products under the same conditions could reduce overall profitability.

2. Dependence on particular customer segments and regions.
The Consumer segment contributes 50.56% of total sales, while the West and East are the two strongest regions. A decline in consumer spending or sales performance in these regions could significantly affect revenue.

3. Weak sales in some geographic markets.
North Dakota, West Virginia, and Maine recorded sales of $919.91, $1,209.82, and $1,270.53 respectively. These low figures may indicate limited demand or market penetration, although further investigation is needed before concluding that these markets are underperforming.

4.3 Three Business Opportunities

1. Expand successful Technology and high-profit products.
Technology leads the categories in sales and profit, while Copiers, Phones, and Accessories are among the strongest sub-categories by profit. The company could build on these strengths through targeted promotions, improved product availability, and appropriate inventory planning.

2. Strengthen sales in the Central and South regions.
The Central and South regions recorded lower sales than the West and East. The company could investigate local customer preferences, improve marketing, and test targeted promotions to increase sales in these regions.

3. Improve the profitability of underperforming products.
Reviewing the prices, supplier costs, discounts, and sales conditions of loss-making products—particularly Tables and Bookcases—could reduce losses. The company could also investigate whether high-selling but loss-making products, such as the Cisco TelePresence System EX90, are affected by excessive discounts or high costs.

Conclusion

The dashboard shows that the company generates substantial revenue, with Technology, Consumer customers, and the West region contributing significantly to performance. However, losses in certain product sub-categories and differences in regional sales present areas for improvement. Addressing these issues while investing in profitable products and markets could help the company strengthen its profitability and achieve more sustainable growth.